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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 3

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Afiliación a la biblioteca

Assistant: Good afternoon, City Library. How can I help you?

Member: Hi, I'd like to sign up for a library membership, please.

Assistant: Of course. Can I take your full name?

Assistant: Before we start entering details, I should explain how I handle a library-membership enquiry. I will establish the essential details first, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Member: That approach works well for me for the library-membership enquiry. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Member: It's Sophie Marsh.

Assistant: And your date of birth?

Member: The fourteenth of March, 1998.

Member: For this library-membership enquiry, I am trying to balance cost with convenience. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Assistant: Of course. In this library-membership enquiry, I will separate firm conditions from optional features, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Assistant: Thank you. Your address?

Member: Flat 7, 33 Berkley Street, Oxford. The postcode is OX1 4PL.

Assistant: And a contact number?

Assistant: A library-membership enquiry can involve names, dates and choices that need to be compared rather than heard in isolation. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Member: I will. For the library-membership enquiry, that will help me make a considered decision, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Member: My home phone is 01865 552 784.

Assistant: Do you have an email address?

Member: Yes, it's sophie.marsh@greenmail.co.uk.

Assistant: Let me finish the library-membership enquiry by summarising what I have recorded. For this library-membership enquiry, I will review the choices in their final form, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the library-membership enquiry, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Member: Good. During the library-membership enquiry, I will listen carefully and interrupt if anything sounds different.

Assistant: What type of membership are you interested in? We offer standard, which gives you up to eight books for three weeks.

Member: I think standard is fine for now.

Member: Before we close the library-membership enquiry, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Assistant: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Assistant: Great. There's a one-off registration fee of two pounds.

Member: That's fine. Can I also reserve books online?

Assistant: Yes, with standard membership you can reserve up to three books at a time through our website.

Assistant: Before I close this library-membership enquiry, I will separate the details we have confirmed from the points that remain optional. Please listen to the complete summary before responding, because correcting one item can sometimes affect a later choice as well. I will keep the original order so that it is easy to compare with your notes.

Member: That is helpful. I will check each detail as you read it and ask about anything that does not match what I intended. Once the summary is accurate, I will also note the reference and the method for making a later amendment.

Assistant: Premium membership gives you twelve books and access to our digital archive.

Assistant: Are you interested in any particular subject area? We can send you newsletters about new arrivals.

Member: Yes, I'm mainly interested in history and science.

Assistant: We will make that final check slowly, preserve the order of the information and correct any difference before treating the record as complete.

Assistant: Noted. The card usually takes five working days to arrive by post. In the meantime, I can give you a temporary pass for today.

Member: That's great. Thank you.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Charla sobre un programa de reciclaje

Good evening, everyone. Thank you for coming along to tonight's community meeting. My name is Rachel Davis, and I work for the council's environmental services team. Tonight I want to tell you about our new residential recycling programme, which launches next month. First, the background. Our borough currently recycles about 32% of its household waste, which is below the national average of 45%. The new programme aims to raise that figure to at least 55% by the end of the year. Before describing the individual features of this recycling-programme briefing, it is useful to understand the overall sequence. The information for the recycling-programme briefing follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, following the main route before considering possible variations.

Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the recycling-programme briefing easier to follow. So what's changing? The biggest change is the introduction of separate bins for food waste. Up to now, food waste has been going into general waste. Starting next month, every household will receive a small kitchen caddy for collecting food scraps, which will be emptied into a larger outdoor bin collected weekly. The material will go to an anaerobic digestion plant where it is converted into energy and compost. Some arrangements connected with the recycling-programme briefing may depend on the time of day or the number of visitors. During the recycling-programme briefing, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time.

Where a condition in the recycling-programme briefing is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. We're also expanding what can go into the dry recycling bin. From next month, you'll be able to recycle plastic film - like the wrapping on ready meals and carrier bags. Previously this had to go to collection points at supermarkets. As the recycling-programme briefing continues, staff may direct different groups along slightly different routes. Within the recycling-programme briefing, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme. If an alternative becomes necessary during the recycling-programme briefing, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available. Glass will no longer go in your mixed recycling bin. You'll need to use the bottle banks in the area - we're adding six new bottle bank sites across the borough to make this more convenient. Do not try to memorise every detail of the recycling-programme briefing at once. The key locations and decisions will be repeated in context. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. Paper and card should still go in the blue bin, rinsed cans and tins in the green bin.

A final way to follow the recycling-programme briefing is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. General advice supports the visit, while a firm instruction must be followed. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. We know change takes some getting used to. So each household will receive a printed guide through the post, and there's a new website at recycleright.gov.uk with videos and a postcode checker to find your nearest bottle bank. If you become uncertain during the

recycling-programme briefing, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking.

Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence. This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity. If you have questions, our helpline is open Monday to Friday, eight to six. The number is 0800 445 6712. Thank you. Before the recycling-programme briefing moves to its final practical details, remember that similar locations or services may have different conditions. Listen for the full name, the direction attached to it and any time restriction.

A descriptive example may help you recognise a place, but only a direct instruction tells you to change route or take action. If a temporary arrangement replaces the normal one, the replacement will be stated after the original is identified. This final distinction connects the earlier overview with the choices that follow and helps prevent a familiar name from being confused with the service currently available.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Seminario sobre agricultura urbana

Tutor: Right, let's begin. You've both looked at the reading on urban farming. What were your initial impressions?

Lee: I found it really interesting. I hadn't realised how many different forms urban farming can take - rooftop gardens, vertical farms with stacked layers, and community allotments.

Anna: Yes. What struck me most was the potential for urban farming to address food security issues in cities. If residents can grow some of their own produce, that reduces dependence on supply chains that can be disrupted.

Tutor: Before we settle on an interpretation for the urban-farming seminar, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Lee: Agreed. For the urban-farming seminar, we can distinguish the central finding from our early assumptions. That will make the argument more credible.

Tutor: Good point. Can you say more about that, Anna?

Anna: Well, during the pandemic, a lot of city residents suddenly became aware of how fragile the food distribution network was. Urban farms can provide a buffer against those kinds of shocks.

Lee: I'd add that there's also a social dimension. Community gardens can help build relationships between neighbours who might otherwise never interact. There's evidence that social cohesion in areas with active community gardens is significantly higher.

Lee: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the urban-farming seminar. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Tutor: Yes. A cautious conclusion is better than an unsupported causal claim.

Tutor: That's been well documented. What about the challenges?

Anna: Space is obviously a major constraint in dense urban areas. Land is expensive, and there's always competition from housing and commercial development.

Lee: I read that one model that's become popular is vertical farming - growing crops in stacked layers inside controlled environments. It uses far less land, but the energy costs can be very high.

Tutor: Another question is whether our categories for the urban-farming seminar are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Lee: For the urban-farming seminar, let us test the instructions on somebody outside the group. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Tutor: Yes, that's one of the key criticisms of vertical farming. If the electricity comes from fossil fuels, the carbon footprint can actually be worse than conventional agriculture.

Anna: So the viability really depends on the energy source. Renewable energy would change that calculation entirely.

Lee: The order of the urban-farming seminar presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Tutor: For the urban-farming seminar, we can introduce the question, present only the method needed for the finding, and move secondary detail to an appendix.

Lee: Another challenge is expertise. A lot of urban residents simply don't know how to grow food. There's a need for training and ongoing support.

Tutor: Exactly. Some cities have addressed this by embedding agricultural education into school curricula. What conclusions would you draw from all this?

Anna: I think urban farming is most viable as a complement to, rather than a replacement for, conventional agriculture. It can provide fresh produce locally and build community, but it can't feed entire cities.

Tutor: Our final review of the urban-farming seminar should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Lee: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can compare our independent checks and revise only where they reveal a problem.

Lee: I agree. And for it to succeed long-term, there needs to be policy support - planning regulations that make it easier to establish urban farms, and subsidies to offset the high costs.

Tutor: Very thoughtful. Let's write up some of those points for next week's presentation.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: Conferencia sobre la historia de la escritura

Writing is arguably the most transformative invention in human history. Today I want to trace the origins and development of written language from its earliest forms to the widespread literacy of the modern era. The earliest known writing system is cuneiform, developed by the Sumerians of ancient Mesopotamia around 3200 BCE. Originally pictographic - that is, based on simple pictures representing objects - cuneiform evolved over centuries into a more abstract system of wedge-shaped marks pressed into clay tablets with a reed stylus. It was used mainly for administrative and commercial record-keeping: lists of goods, taxes, and transactions. To place the history-of-writing lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it.

Within the history-of-writing lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through several pathways rather than one smooth sequence. A simple list of events in the history-of-writing lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. Independently, and around the same time, hieroglyphics emerged in ancient Egypt. Like early cuneiform, Egyptian hieroglyphics began as a pictographic system but also developed sound symbols, making it a mixed system. Hieroglyphics were used not only for administration but also for religious texts, royal inscriptions, and later, literary works. Evidence for the history-of-writing lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare historical material with evidence gathered using modern instruments.

Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. Both systems were highly complex and required years of specialist training to master. Literacy was therefore restricted to a small professional class of scribes, who held considerable social power. Scale is especially important when evaluating the history-of-writing lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this history-of-writing lecture, the lecture will return to this distinction in each case study. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful.

A fundamental change came with the development of alphabetic writing. The first true alphabet - in which each symbol represents a consonant sound - is generally attributed to the Phoenicians, around 1050 BCE. This system spread to the Greeks, who made the crucial innovation of adding vowels, producing the first complete alphabet. The Roman alphabet, derived from Greek, became the basis for most European writing systems in use today. It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the history-of-writing lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. Scientific caution does not mean that every account is equally likely. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together.

Because alphabets have far fewer symbols than logographic or syllabic systems - typically between twenty and thirty - they are much easier to learn. This made widespread literacy possible for the first

time. The separate examples in the history-of-writing lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the history-of-writing lecture, it also makes similarities visible without pretending that every case is identical. The conclusion to the history-of-writing lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence. The invention of the printing press by Johannes Gutenberg around 1440 CE was the next watershed moment.

By enabling the mass reproduction of texts, it dramatically accelerated the spread of literacy and of new ideas across Europe, and contributed directly to transformations such as the Reformation and the Scientific Revolution. A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the history-of-writing lecture less convincing. Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together.

Today, digital technology has again changed the nature of writing and reading, creating new genres and new challenges - including the decline of handwriting, the rise of informal written communication, and ongoing debates about what literacy means in a digital age.